SoIM School of Innovation and Management
Innovate. Include. Inspire.

Design Thinking Project Expo 2026
Innovative Design Thinking for Entrepreneurship & Business Development

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Voice-first · Vernacular · Near-zero cost

DukaanGo

Any local shopkeeper gets a searchable digital storefront in under 10 minutes — by speaking, in their own language.

Scan to try the live demo

1 The problem

Local shops are invisible online. The modern customer journey starts at a search bar — and they are not in it.

> *"We didn't even know your shop existed. We searched Google for 'grocery near me' and it didn't show up."*

- Fewer than **10%** of Indian MSMEs have a meaningful digital presence
- Ramesh's 25-year-old kirana shop lost **35% of sales** in two years
- Quick-commerce and D2C brands absorb the footfall

2 User & empathy study

30+ shopkeeper interviews — kirana stores, tailors, salons, street vendors, repair shops. Aged 35–60, smartphone users, WhatsApp-fluent.

- **Language** — tools are English-first
- **Intimidation** — 'SEO', 'catalog' feel alien
- **Cost** — "who has ₹15,000 for a website?"
- **Time** — running the shop alone leaves no bandwidth

> *"I tried making a Google listing but gave up — too many forms in English."*

3 The insight

The barrier is not willingness. It is the interface.

> *Reframe: stop teaching shopkeepers to use technology. Build technology that already speaks their language.*

- WhatsApp proved vernacular, conversational UI wins in Bharat
- UPI proved simple UX drives mass adoption in non-tech audiences
- Voice input adoption among rural smartphone users is now **60%+**

4 Design Thinking applied

Empathize
30+ field interviews with shop owners across 6 trades

Define
How might we get a non-tech shopkeeper online in 10 minutes, in their language, at near-zero cost?

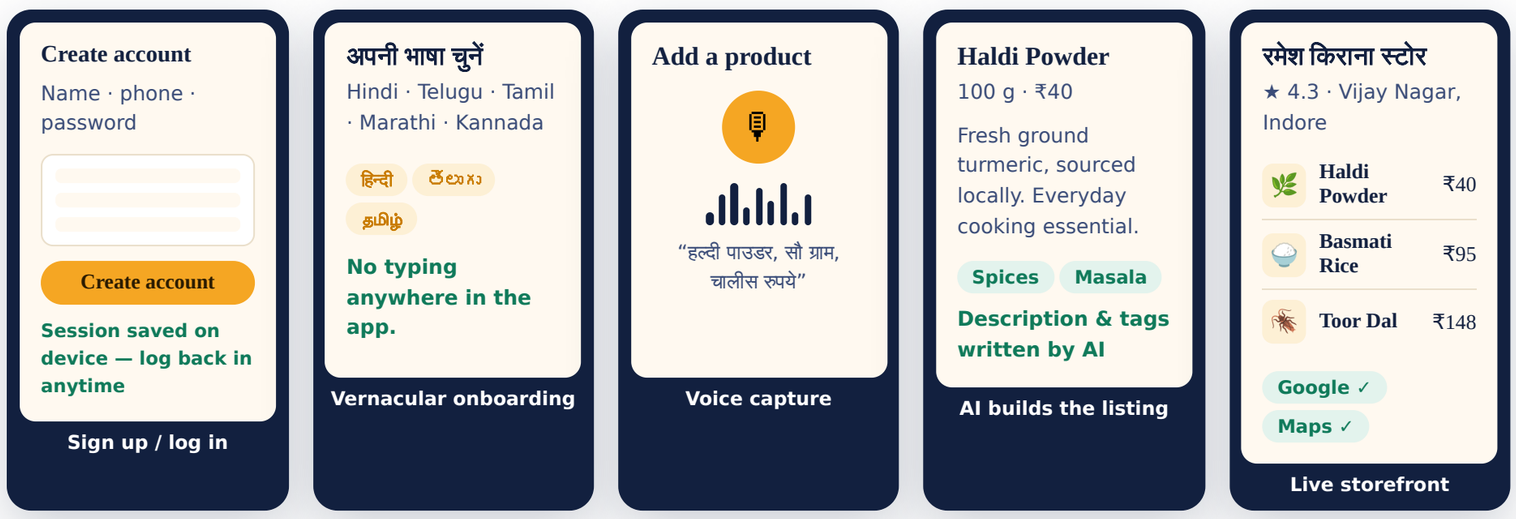
Ideate
4 concepts weighed. Training camps, marketplace and chatbot rejected on scale, competition and discovery.

Prototype
Voice-first vernacular app that auto-builds the storefront and pushes it everywhere

Test
50 shopkeepers, Indore, 30 days. Measured setup time, weekly use, new customers, revenue lift.

5 Working prototype

A clickable demo runs on the phone at this table. Speak once — the app writes the listing, builds the page, and publishes it.



6 What makes it different

- **Real sign-up / log in** — create an account, session persists on your device
- **Voice-first onboarding** — no typing, no forms, no English
- **AI writes the work** — descriptions, categories, tags, offer posters
- **Built-in distribution** — auto-syncs to Google Business, Maps, WhatsApp Catalog, Instagram
- **Hyperlocal discovery** — a customer app that surfaces the shop 240 m away
- **Runs on entry-level Android** with low data usage

> *No existing tool handles onboarding + discovery + catalog + messaging together, in a vernacular voice interface, at near-zero cost.*

7 Usefulness in real life

10 min
from install to a shop discoverable on Google Maps

₹0
to start — storefront and catalog free forever

60M+
MSMEs addressable in India; 15M with smartphones

110M
livelihoods supported by the businesses this serves

For the shopkeeper
Visible on search, takes UPI orders through WhatsApp, runs a digital khata — without learning a new app or hiring anyone.

For the neighbourhood
Customers find what is actually near them. The tea stall 120 m away competes with a 10-minute delivery app.

Business model
Freemium core. Pro at ₹99/month, 1–2% on UPI orders, FMCG hyperlocal ads, and referral commissions on working-capital loans.

An inclusion engine, not just an app.

Local shops are the cultural and economic fabric of India, yet the digital revolution is making them invisible. The problem was never a lack of will — it was a lack of accessible tools. DukaanGo gives every kirana, tailor and tea stall a fair shot in the digital economy.

Next: ONDC integration · AI demand forecasting · embedded credit & BNPL · Tier-3/4 and South-East Asia